

To
all offices
– excluding University Administration –
– excluding University Hospital Bonn (UKB) –

Information and Data Security
Unit

Dr. Eva Tiefenau
Information Security Officer

Adenauerallee 72–74
53113 Bonn
Phone: +49 228/73-4554
tiefenau@verwaltung.uni-bonn.de

File reference:

Bonn, July 24, 2025

Circular No. 26/2025

Support (security updates) for Windows 10 ending

Dear Sir or Madam, dear colleagues,

In this circular we wish to inform you that some Microsoft products currently in use at the University will not be supported after October 14, 2025. Accordingly, [Windows 10, older versions of Windows 11 and Microsoft Office 2016 and 2019](#) will no longer receive updates. This means that emerging security vulnerabilities will no longer be fixed by Microsoft as of that date. Devices running the affected products at that time will be vulnerable to cyberattack. Use of these products after October 14, 2025 therefore represents an unacceptable risk.

Your available options for addressing this situation are outlined below.

You are requested to please coordinate with your local administrators on this issue, or contact the [Digitalization Managers](#) or [University IT](#) if you have any further questions.

Employees who received their device from Division 2 do not have to contact Support or take any other steps.

If you are currently using one of the above-mentioned versions of [Microsoft Windows](#), you have the following recommended options:

1. **Update to a current version of Windows 11.** We recommend switching to the Education or Enterprise editions, as these have more GDPR-relevant configuration options. Post-installation you can use the free, optional tool [ShutUp10++](#) to configure privacy settings. Configuration recommendations are posted in the [Service Portal](#). Please note that not all devices are able to run Windows 11. Visit the [Microsoft](#) website for an overview of the system requirements which your device must meet.
2. If your device is unable to run Windows 11, we recommend **switching to a more modern device** which has Windows 11 pre-installed (preferably the Education or Enterprise editions), or is capable of running these.
3. If you are unable to switch to a new device immediately for financial reasons, or if continuing to use Windows 10 makes sense for you for other reasons, you can use the Pro version of the software [Opatch](#) as a temporary solution until you purchase a new device. [Microsoft](#) extended security updates currently require a "Campus EES contract".

4. If you do **not have to use** Windows, **switching over to Linux, such as the [Ubuntu](#)** operating system, represents a data protection-compliant alternative to updating to Windows 11.

Special cases:

- If a device is used exclusively locally (no use of LAN, WLAN, VPN or mobile data), you can continue running it on Windows 10. In such case, please contact your local administrator in order to implement appropriate security configurations (such as deactivating network interfaces).
- The use of personal devices on University of Bonn networks which run systems or applications that no longer receive security updates poses an unacceptable risk. The above measures thus represent recommendations for such devices. For personal devices Microsoft offers [security updates](#) for a one-year period.

For users of Office 2016 and Office 2019:

Please upgrade to newer local version (Office 2024, license from Microsoft Select Plus - [ASKnet Shop](#)) or use alternative like [LibreOffice](#).

signed
Tiefenau